

SSI PROGRAM

Indiana Economic Development Corp

SOLAR SCREENING

SSI PHASE I: SITE DISCOVERY

PROJECT SCOPE

Indiana is currently experiencing significant investments in renewable energy, including solar farms. To support solar energy projects, LL+D initiated statewide SSI Solar Phase I: Site Discovery to identify new opportunities for utility-scale solar farms. These solar sites are potential renewable energy sources for power generation diversification that may serve as important assets to Indiana's growing economy while contributing to environmental stewardship.

SSI Solar Core Suitability Models were developed as a site screening tool to create areas of interest (AOI). Positive factors included proximity to existing electrical infrastructure, industrial zoning & land uses, and inclusion within coal closure energy communities. Negative factors included environmental/engineering constraints such as wetlands, flood zone, slope, poorly draining soils, and heavily forested areas. AOI were visually explored to identify potential sites, while setbacks were given for residential development and culturally sensitive areas. To estimate site potential power generation capacity, a range of 0.12 to 0.2 MW per acre was used, yielding an estimated range of 120-200 MW per 1,000 acres.

SOLAR CORE SUITABILITY MODEL INPUTS

- 1,000+ ACRES
- TRANSMISSION LINES NEAR
- SUBSTATIONS NEAR
- NO WETLANDS
- NO FLOOD ZONES
- NO SLOPE/ ELEVATION
- NO CULTURAL FEATURES NEAR
- NO EXISTING DEVELOPMENT

WHAT MAKES AN SSI SOLAR SITE?

ELECTRIC INFRASRUCTUTRE

The ideal solar site is located near substations and transmission lines to meet energy demands.

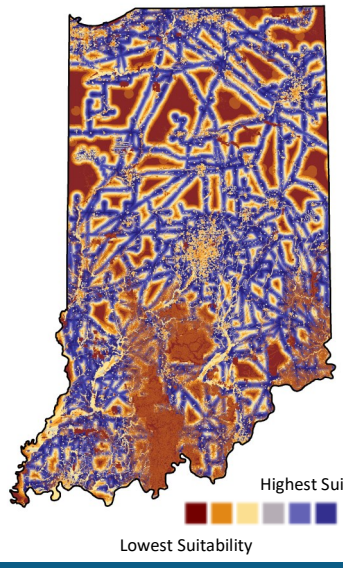
DRY & FLAT LAND

Large tracts of land that is not wet or heavily sloped is crucial for solar panel placement.

APPROPRIATE SETBACK

Buffers are given to sensitive areas like schools, hospitals, churches, parks, and other community features.

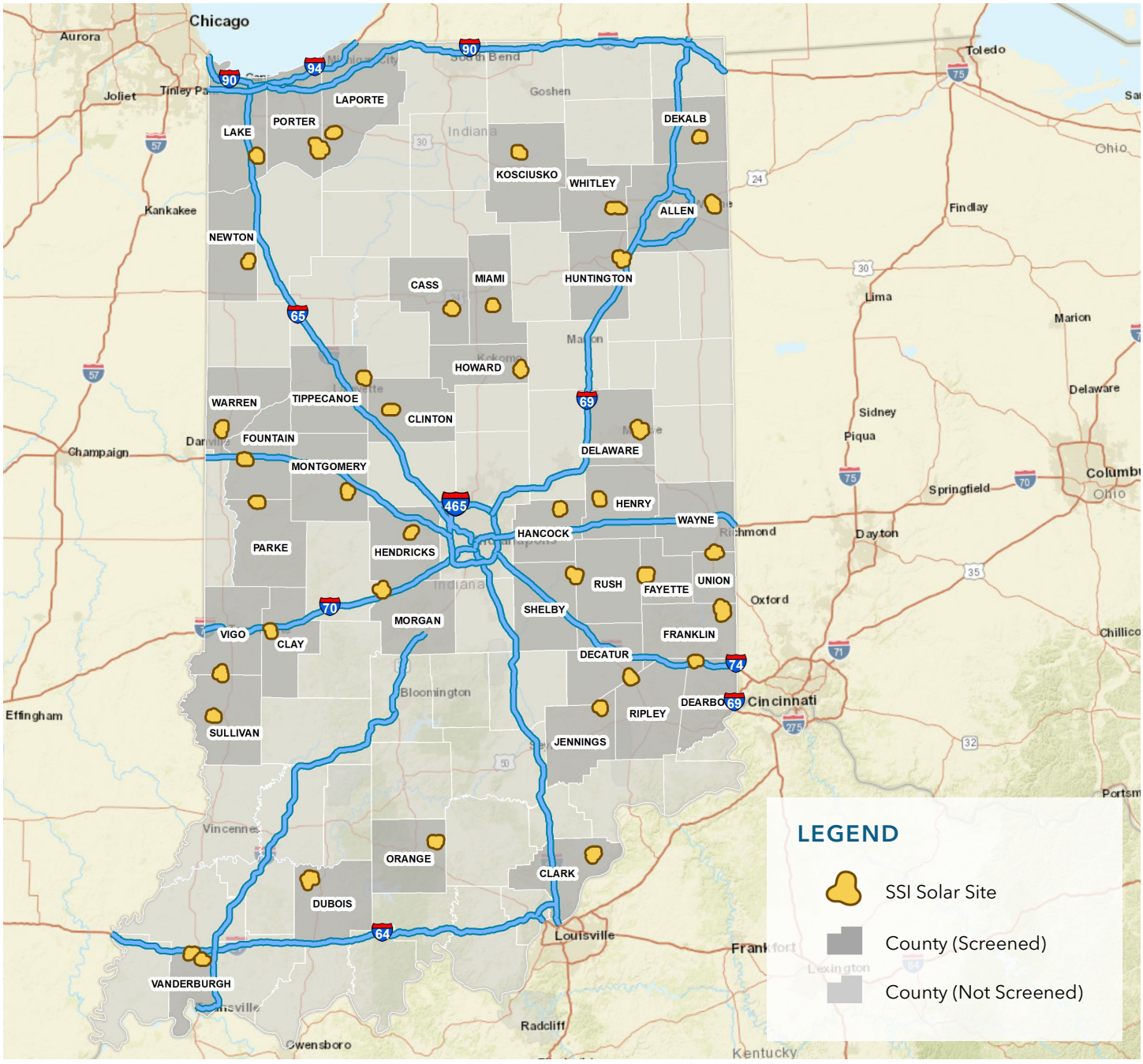
SOLAR CORE SUITABILITY MODEL OUTPUT



SSI SOLAR SITE

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SSI PHASE I: SOLAR SITE SEARCH RESULTS



38	1,722	266 MW	65,433	10,142 MW	7.2
SOLAR SITES IDENTIFIED	AVERAGE ACRES	AVERAGE MEGAWATTS	TOTAL ACRES	TOTAL MEGAWATTS	AVERAGE LANDOWNERS